



Divine experience: A qawwali session at the Hazrat Nizamuddin Dargah provided the diary with a much-needed reprieve amid a tight schedule. Elsewhere, the face-painters were kept on their toes during the Delhi leg of WPL.

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from the cops with slightly infuriating shrugs when asked how the diary was to file the reports without laptops.

A Delhi Capitals game against UP Warriorz left reporters particularly chagrined. DC's lower end, composed of Indian players, botched up what looked like a comfortable chase, losing against UP Warriorz by a solitary run. It brought back memories of the 2017 Women's World Cup final, where the Indian tail fell short in a nine-run loss to England. The night was endured with some waffles and ice cream.

The DC vs UPW match initiated a series of nail-biting final-over finishes, depleting the diary's energy. Amidst frantic story filing, she sought comfort in a soulful qawwali session at Hazrat

Nizamuddin Dargah. The diary explored Delhi's night charm, visiting India Gate, Parliament, and Khan Market. On Eliminator day, the diary unwound in 'Delhi-6', indulging in Kake di Hatti's famous naans and Jama Masjid's beauty.

On the eve of the final, the WPL had organised a light and sound show at the iconic Qutb Minar, a towering 13th-century sandstone marvel. While filing previews and researching ahead of the summit clash meant the diary could not visit the monument, she spotted a tower with projections similar to what she had seen on WPL's social media handles in the background of a preview video recorded outside the Kotla.

In a comical sequence of events to follow, the diary and her colleagues were convinced that this was the Qutb Minar they had seen. After a few

minutes spent wondering why the UNESCO heritage site was not spotted in the 10 days prior, the diary and her colleagues impulsively redirected the rickshaw, undertaking a 40-minute ride to the site. **The diary reached the monument 10 minutes after the show was done, but she consoled herself by saying that she had tried.**

The diary proceeded to narrate this story quite proudly to her colleagues, even determined to show them this 'Qutb Minar' she had spotted beyond the Kotla Stadium. That it turned out to be quite an unremarkable industrial tower was enough to make the diary want to bury her head in the sand forever.

The RCB players did not sleep after winning the trophy. Neither did the diary. The next afternoon was spent with the champions, trying to draw out as many anecdotes as possible.

After spending the day in the company of veterans of the women's game, the diary could take solace in knowing that it had one thing in common with the likes of Perry: they both just about made it in time for their flights back to their respective destinations.

